



Sarobar Lake — colloquially known simply as ‘Lake’ — is a favourite spot for people to idle away time at any hour of the day. Cubbon Park had the same charm, only on a much grander scale. Friends were enjoying picnics on the sprawling lawns, lovers strolled hand-in-hand, and, to the Diary’s surprise, Pokémon Go was still a thing — groups of boys and men aimlessly walking around or perched on benches, eyes glued to their screens.

Wandering along one of the many nature trails, the Diary spotted a tree adorned with vibrant yellow flowers, a striking contrast against the green grass and the blue sky.

Seeking the perfect vantage point for the 35mm lens to capture the scene, the Diary climbed to a higher perch and clicked. Fortunately, that shot marked the final frame on the roll of film, and the Diary exhaled in relief.

Now back in Chennai, it eagerly awaits the grainy photographs to be developed, ready to relive the sights of the Garden City once more.

Rajdeep Saha

Fan favourites

In the Indian Premier League’s 17-year history, it is no secret that Mumbai Indians, Royal Challengers Bengaluru, and Chennai Super Kings have established the largest fan bases. While the WPL is only three years old, MI and RCB (CSK does not have a franchise in the WPL) are already benefiting from their vast networks of supporters. In Lucknow, where the WPL was being staged for the first time, a sizeable number of fans were backing these two franchises. Even the counterfeit jerseys sold by hawkers outside the Ekana Cricket Stadium were largely those of MI, RCB, and CSK.

When asked about home advantage while playing in Vadodara during the opening phase of this year’s WPL, Gujarat Giants skipper Ashleigh Gardner said: “Yeah, I mean, home advantage, I don’t know about that, but there were a lot of RCB fans wherever we went. Hopefully, with the game growing and hitting different parts of India, we can have Gujarat fans wherever we go.”

Rousing reception: In Lucknow, where the WPL was being staged for the first time, a sizeable number of fans turned up for the matches.

SANDEEP SAXENA

Among the fans in attendance for the game between MI and GG on March 6 was 22-year-old Divyanshu. A native of Delhi, he is currently completing his internship in Lucknow. Like a true Delhiite, his loyalty lies with Virat Kohli and RCB. “I’m a Kohli fan. In the WPL, I like Smriti Mandhana and Ellyse Perry too,” he said.

He had also attended the WPL Eliminator and final at the Arun Jaitley Stadium in Delhi last year. “There was considerable buzz in Delhi for the WPL last year. In Lucknow, the venue is slightly away from the heart of the city. That may be a factor in the lukewarm response to the league here,” he observed. However, he concluded on an optimistic note: “The WPL is definitely growing. The players are becoming more familiar to the fans.”

Vivek Krishnan